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GOOD JIHADI/BAD JIHADI

Al-Qaeda's attack against America altered the militant landscape in Pakistan and the subsequent assault against India's Parliament in December 2001 allowed New Delhi to invoke the US response to 9/11, arguing it had a similar right to pursue any terrorist outfits that had attacked it and to hold their state sponsors accountable. As India massed troops along the border, Pakistan responded by doing the same. This created immediate complications for US efforts in Afghanistan, while war threatened to destabilize South Asia. American and Indian pressure on Pakistan was severe, and the Musharraf regime was forced to ban Lashkar and several other outfits in January 2002. The Markaz al-Dawa wal-Irshad was renamed Jamaat-ul-Dawa, which was technically separated from the now banned Lashkar. This enabled the group to protect its assets, but the operating environment it faced was nonetheless a more challenging one than it had enjoyed only months earlier.

Life after the ban was not as easy for any of Pakistan's jihadi groups as it had been beforehand. Fundraising, recruitment and training were restricted to different degrees for different outfits, but none got off scot-free if only because these activities could no longer be carried out as overtly as hitherto. However, the Musharraf regime had no plans to dismantle all of Pakistan's proxies. As part of what has become known as Pakistan's 'double game,' militant outfits were categorized as 'good jihadis' that were covertly supported for continued use as proxies and 'bad jihadis' that were cracked down on more harshly. This was not a purely binomial division. Assessments and treatment existed on a spectrum, meaning some 'good jihadis' were treated better than others and some 'bad jihadis' cracked down on more harshly. Categorization was based on the threats that a group